04. Neon City

Comet Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/neon.ts

Where it is now

3.15 km: boulevard, market hall, helix up a tower, expressway, double-decker, missing-span jump, canal, plaza or crate alley. Lap 2 trams; last lap blackout.

What is wrong

An empty city. Nothing moves, so it is just a road with buildings.

Core mechanic

Traffic. A living city: cars, buses and trams move along the roads and you weave through them. Some vehicles (car carriers, flatbed trucks) are ramps you can use.

Signature moments

- The double-decker: gaps in the upper deck let you drop to the lower deck mid-lap, and ramps take you back up.
- Billboard wall-ride: neon panels on the expressway you can drive along sideways for a few seconds.
- The helix up the tower, now with traffic coming down the other lane.

Layout changes

- Keep the boulevard, helix and expressway.
- Add drop-gaps between the decks.
- Add two wall-ride billboard sections.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: rush hour, traffic doubles.
- Last lap: power cut; only headlights, signs and the traffic lights show the way.

Engine work needed

- Traffic system: vehicles on lanes, solid, that rivals avoid.
- Wall riding on marked panels.
- Ramps on moving vehicles.

Rivals

- Rivals weave through traffic and use the vehicle ramps.
- Rivals use the deck drops.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.